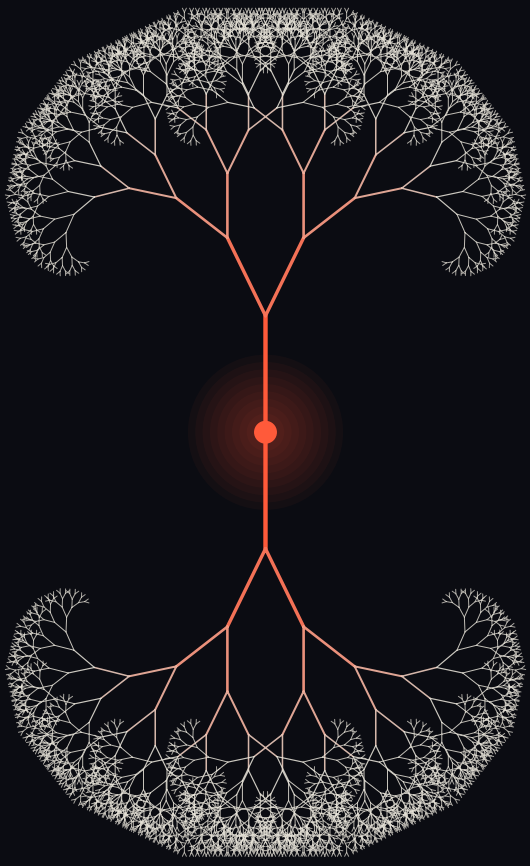
The Source



A vision of consciousness, infinity and return

The Source

A vision of consciousness, infinity and return

One shared origin, two infinities, countless lives, and a return. Fourteen ideas for holding consciousness, death and meaning together. Everything rests on one postulate: each consciousness would be part of a single consciousness, and the rest follows. One difference from the great traditions before it: this origin would not itself know why it exists. This is metaphysics: a vision to explore and to challenge, not a scientific theory.

Contents

The origin

01 The Source 6

02 Two fractals 8

03 Everything and nothing 10

The unfolding

04 Scales 12

05 Several lives at once 14

06 Outside time 16

07 An infinity of worlds 18

Experience

08 Knowing and living 20

09 The balance 22

10 Suffering 24

The return

11 The return 26

12 Life in other forms 28

13 What a life brings 30

The question

14 Why 32

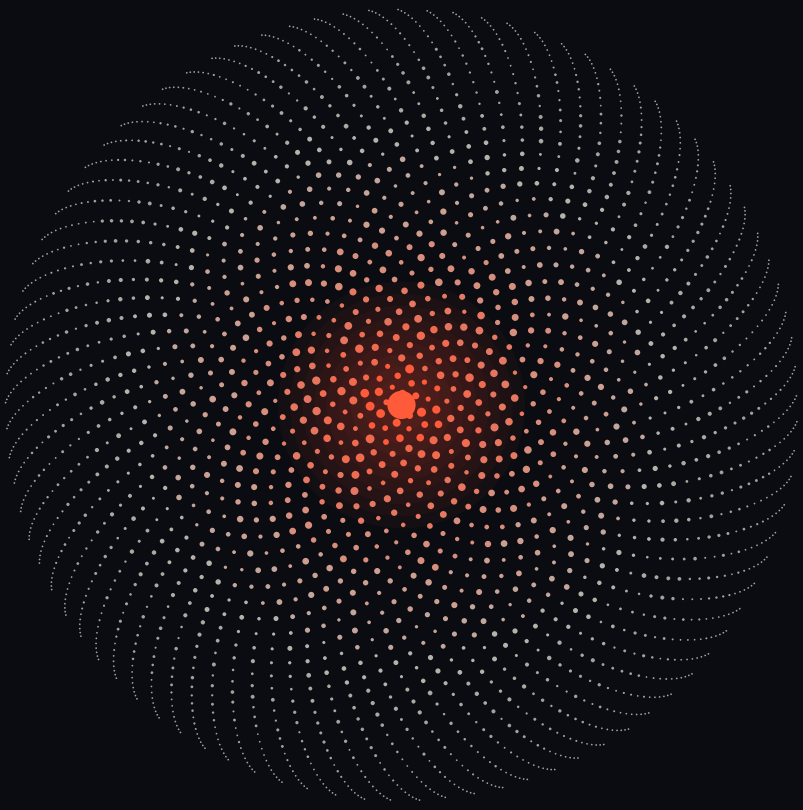
Glossary

A few words come back from one chapter to the next. Here is the sense they take in this book.

Source	The shared origin of everything that exists, which discovers itself by existing.
Fractal	A shape that repeats the same pattern at every scale.
Soul	A vaster consciousness that gathers several lives.
Unfolding	The movement by which the Source takes form in worlds and lives.
Experience	What no knowledge replaces: going through something once, without knowing what comes next.
Freedom	The part of a life no one dictates, since no one, not even the Source, knows what comes next.
Balance	The never-settled equilibrium between all the polarities of what is lived.
Return	Joining the whole and bringing to it what was lived.
Form	A particular, and passing, way of being alive.

The echoes after each chapter prove nothing. They only show that these questions are very old, and that others have asked them differently.

Everything starts from one point, and everything returns to it.



A river can be followed back to a trickle of water between two stones. The intuition is the same at the scale of everything that exists: follow consciousnesses, worlds and matter back to a shared origin. That is what the Source names here. Some would call it God, and the word matters less than the idea.

This origin would not stand above the world looking on. Nor would it hold every answer from the start: it would discover what it is as things come to exist, from within, through each point of view.

Existing would be its way of learning what it is.

The image of the river stops there, because water does not flow back to its source. Here, everything would return. Three movements organise what follows: unfolding, experience, return.

Echoes

Plotinus, *Enneads*, 3rd century. Everything proceeds from the One, and everything longs to turn back toward it.

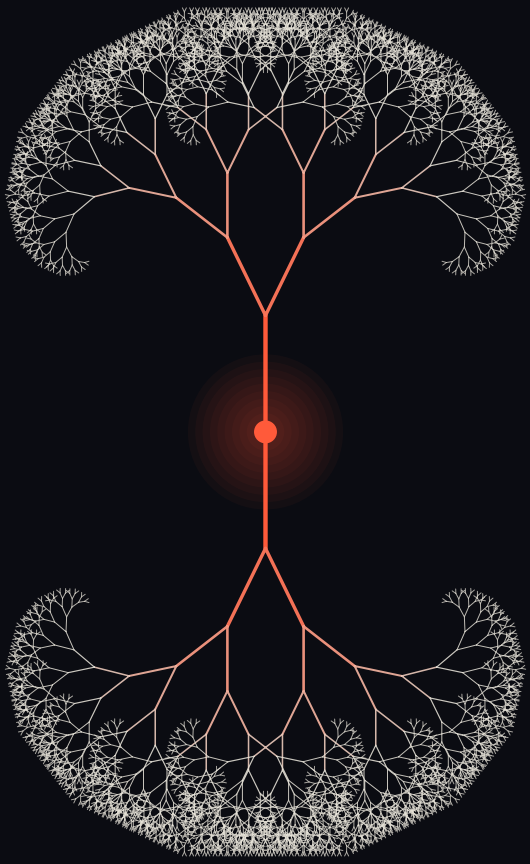
Hegel, *Phenomenology of Spirit*, 1807. The absolute is not given at the outset: Spirit becomes what it is by discovering itself through history.

What remains open

If the Source is the origin of everything, where does it come from?

Two infinities are born from one point.

infinitely large



infinitely small

A fractal repeats one pattern at every scale. Imagine two of them, born from one point. One opens toward the infinitely large: galaxies, clusters, universes, perhaps others still. The other descends toward the infinitely small: cells, atoms, particles, ever deeper levels.

The Source stands at their junction. It is neither the largest nor the smallest element, but what connects the two directions and gives birth to them.

Everything emerges, everything returns, and everything changes on the way.

The movement resembles breathing. Existence stops being a straight line from a beginning to an end: it becomes a living fractal, where one principle acts everywhere. And this pattern, as we will see, holds for consciousness too.

Echoes

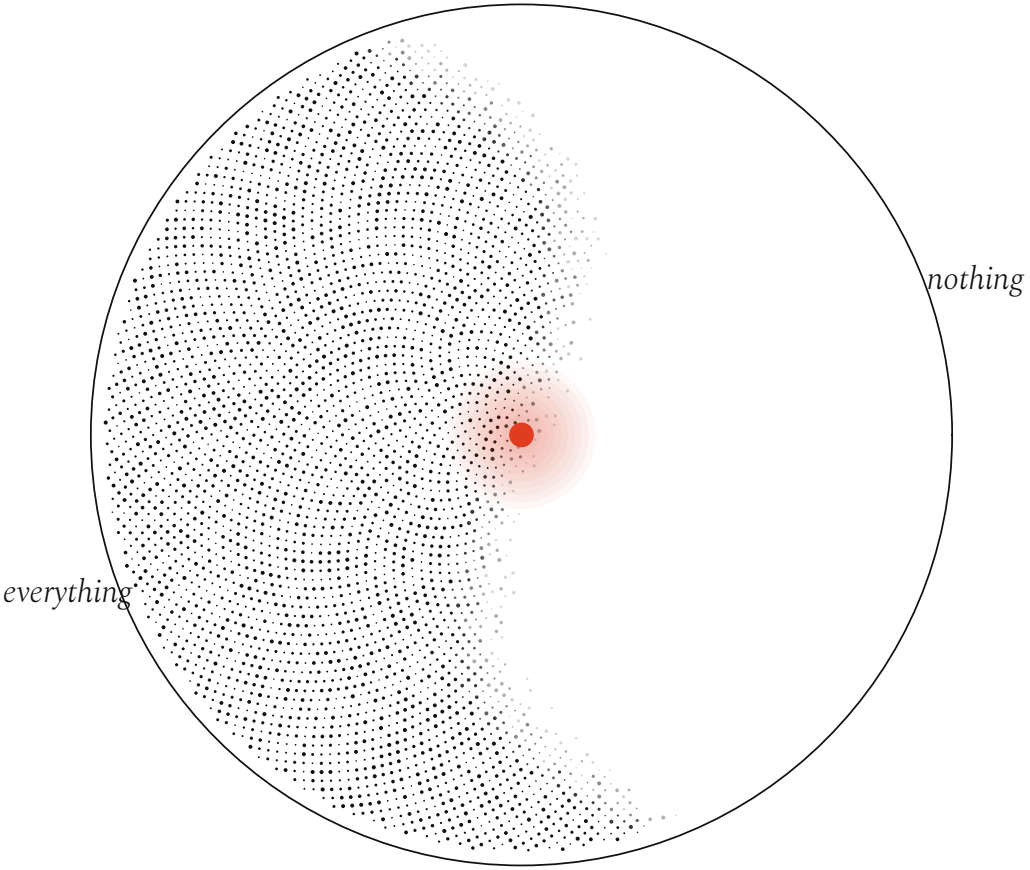
Pascal, *Pensées*, 1670. Humanity suspended between two infinities, the infinitely large and the infinitely small.

Benoît Mandelbrot, *Les Objets fractals*, 1975. The word fractal, for shapes that repeat at every scale.

What remains open

Nothing shows that the universe is fractal. Does the image illuminate reality, or only how we think about it?

The Source is everything and nothing at once.



Everything, because each universe, consciousness and particle would be an expression of it. Nothing, because before any form it would be no thing in particular.

This nothing is not nonexistence. It is an absence of defined form, a reserve of possibilities, close to what Taoism and non-dual thought have explored.

The paradox gives the whole model its engine. Being everything, the Source has nothing to look for outside itself. Being undetermined, it has an infinity of things to discover within.

To create is to pass from possibility to experience.

Echoes

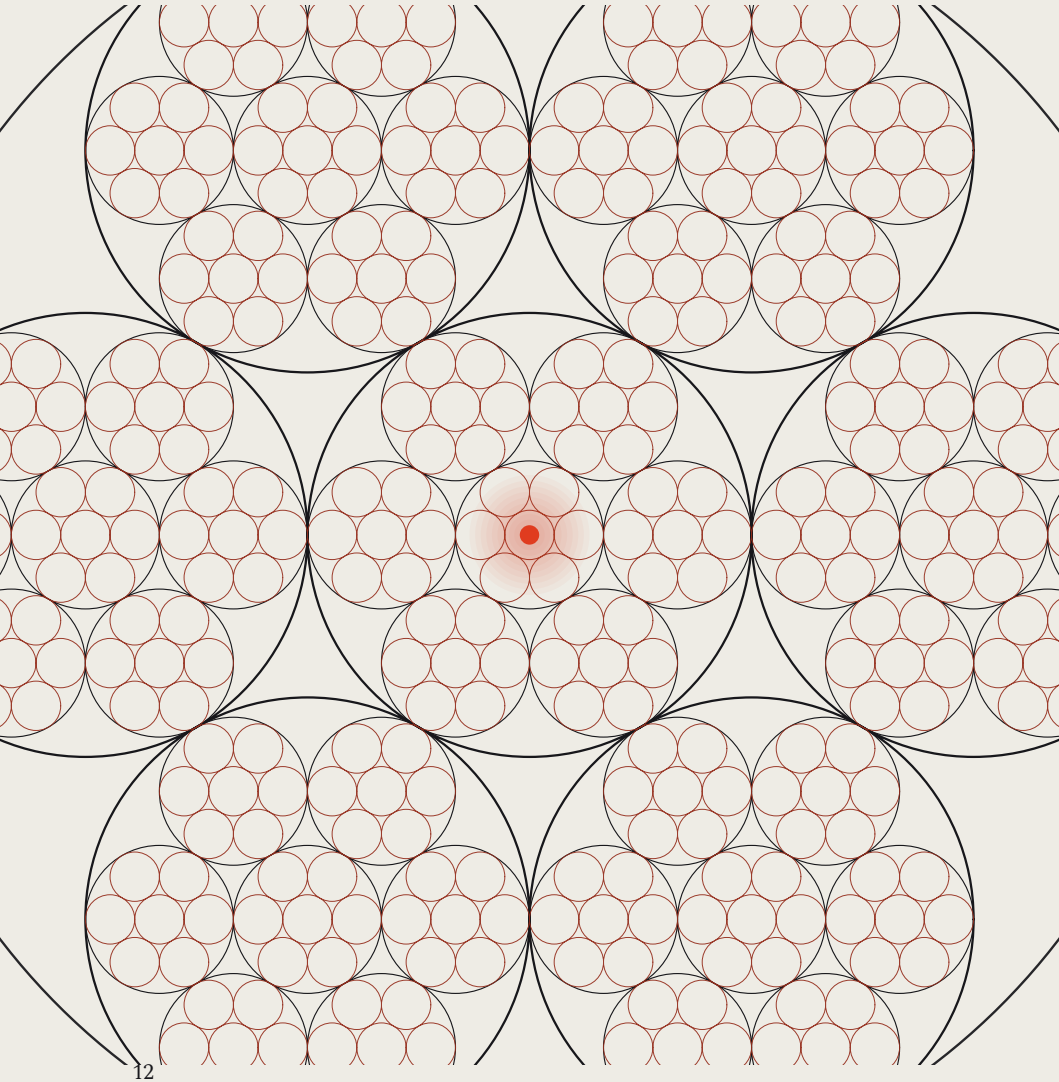
Laozi, *Tao Te Ching*. It is the empty centre of the wheel that makes it useful.

Nicholas of Cusa, *On Learned Ignorance*, 1440. In the infinite, opposites coincide.

What remains open

Can anything be said of an origin that no form defines?

There is no clear border between the individual and the whole.



The pattern repeats at each level. A life belongs to a vaster consciousness, which we can call a soul. That soul belongs to a vaster one still, and so on up to the Source.

Wider does not mean better. No level is worth more than another: each is a different way of looking at the same thing.

Where does the individual end, and universal consciousness begin?

The question may have no clear-cut answer. There would then be a single consciousness, discovering itself through an infinity of points of view, none of which stops being unique.

Echoes

Arthur Koestler, *The Ghost in the Machine*, 1967. The holon: everything that exists is at once a whole and part of a larger whole.

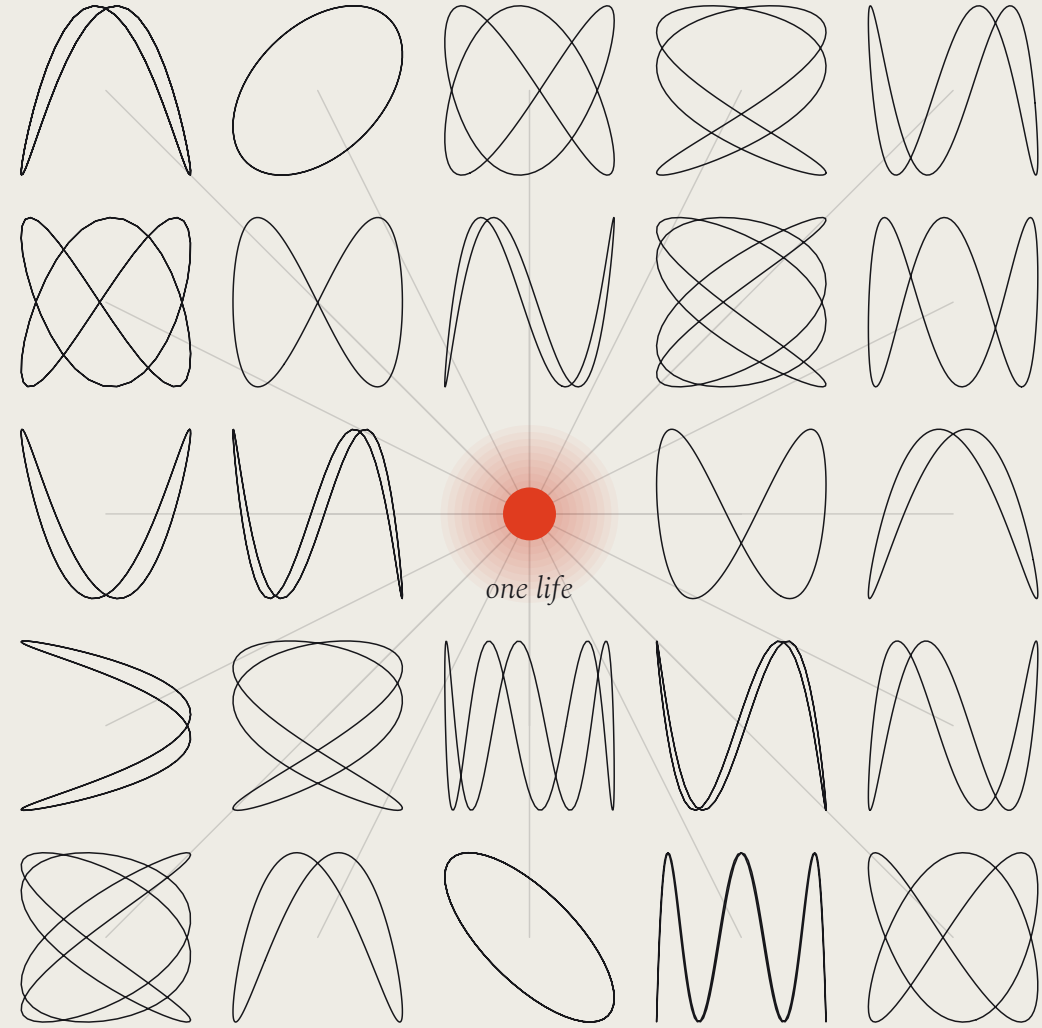
Indra's net, Huayan Buddhism, 7th century. An endless net in which each jewel reflects all the others.

The Upanishads, *Chāndogya Upaniṣad*, c. 6th century BCE. "You are that": each one's self and the absolute are one.

What remains open

If a vaster consciousness guides the lives it gathers, what becomes of each one's freedom?

A soul could live several existences at the same time.



Take twenty-five lives, to make it concrete. Twenty-five distinct people, each with their own emotions and decisions, knowing nothing of one another. Yet all of them feed a single consciousness.

The parallelism has a purpose: to learn more than a single point of view allows. One life discovers courage, another forgiveness, another attachment.

None is a copy of another, and none can be replaced. Each point on the grid sees what the others will never see.

Twenty-five is an image. Nothing imposes a limit.

Echoes

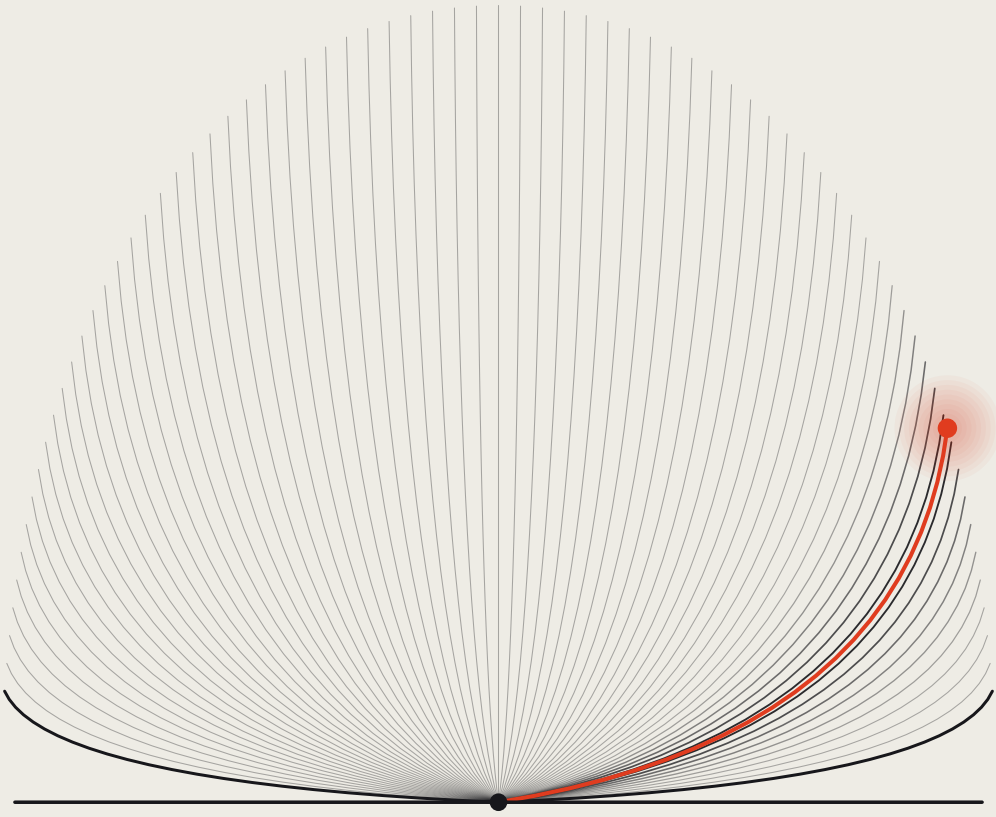
Leibniz, *Monadology*, 1714. Each substance mirrors the universe, from a point of view that belongs to it alone.

Fernando Pessoa, the heteronyms, from 1914. One poet, several complete authors, each with a life and a body of work.

What remains open

No evidence supports the idea of shared lives. What is it worth, then, as a way of looking at others?

Every page of the book exists at the same time.



We read a book page after page, and that is how we live time. But the reader moving forward does not stop the other pages from being there, together, between the two covers.

At the scale of a soul, past, present and future could have this simultaneity. Lives separated by centuries would be neighbours: two pages of one volume, which do not read each other.

The past would not be behind us: only on another page.

They would not command one another. What one life understands would simply enrich the whole, and the others would benefit without knowing its source.

Echoes

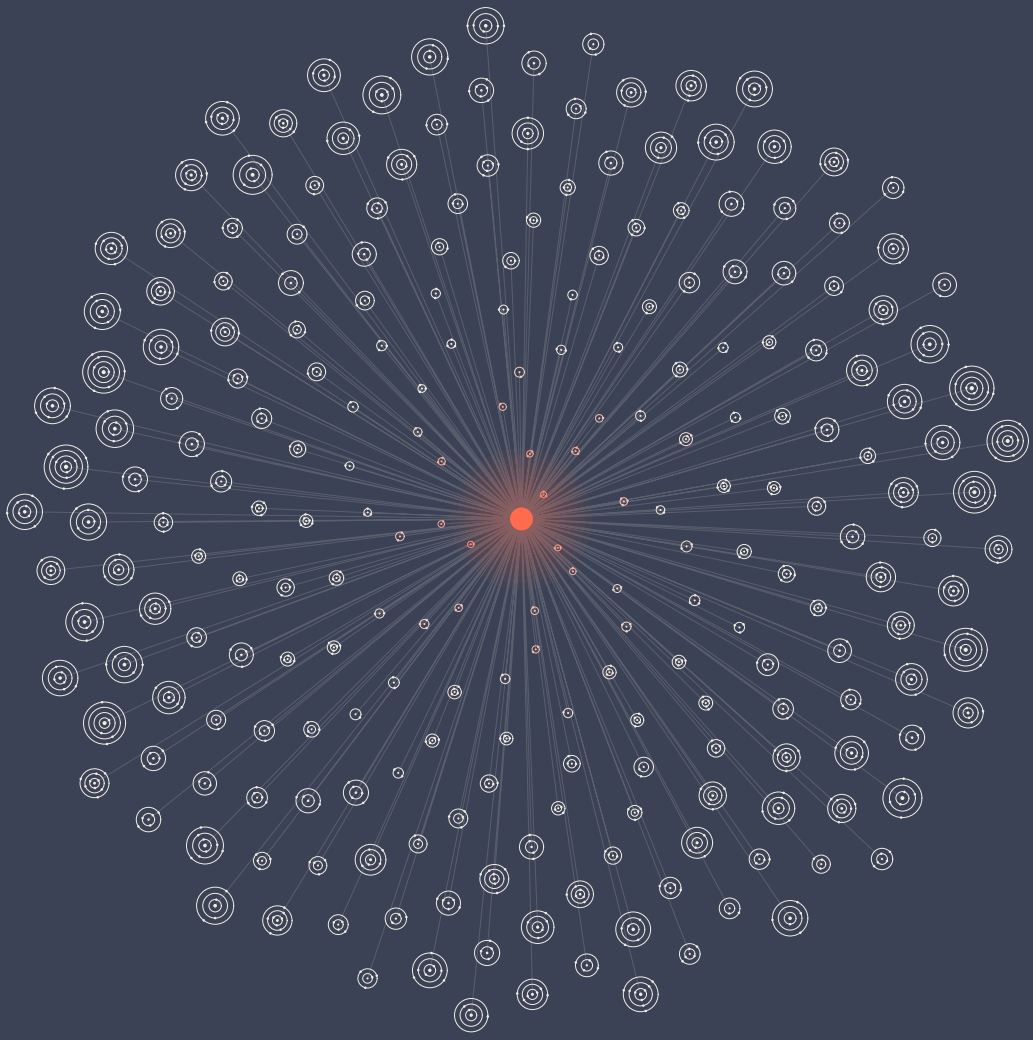
Augustine, *Confessions*, book XI, c. 400. Past and future exist only as present to the mind: memory, attention, expectation.

Hermann Minkowski, *Space and Time*, 1908. Time becomes one dimension among four, and a whole history fits on a single line.

What remains open

The book is an image: it does not show that the future already exists. And if all the pages coexist, are they written as they are lived?

A limitless exploration has no reason to stop at one world.



If the Source explores in order to learn, keeping to one planet, one era or one universe would make no sense. Each world would offer other conditions of existence, and so other possible experiences.

The unity of this whole would come not from any resemblance between worlds, but from their shared origin.

Something would always remain to be discovered.

There would then never be a final perfection. Perfection is here neither a starting state nor a point of arrival, but a direction.

Echoes

Giordano Bruno, *On the Infinite Universe and Worlds*, 1584. Countless worlds, in a universe without edge.

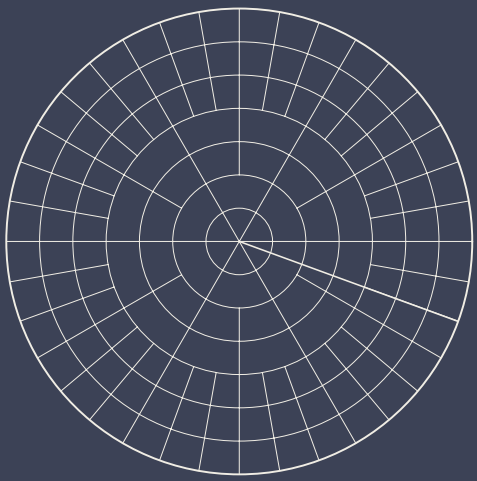
Hugh Everett, doctoral thesis, 1957. A reading of quantum physics in which each possibility is realised in a branch.

Nietzsche, *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*, 1883. Against those who invent other worlds to console themselves for this one. The counterpoint.

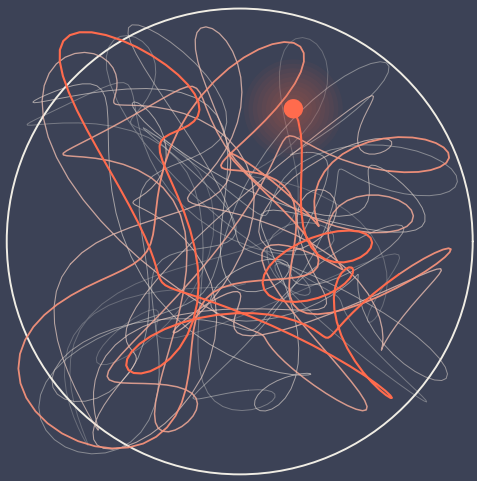
What remains open

The existence of an infinity of universes has not been demonstrated. And does infinity answer the question, or push it away?

To know is not to live.



knowing



living

How could something infinite still learn? Because infinite does not mean knowing everything. The Source would contain every possibility, but containing a possibility is not the same as having passed through it.

It could know the definition of love without ever having trembled for someone, and the definition of grief without ever having waited for someone who will not come back. Knowledge would give it the map of everything. It would not give it the weight.

It would lack what only a life can give: once, here, without knowing what comes next.

An existence would then be nothing like a script known in advance. A stranger's ordinary morning, their fear before opening a letter, the taste of a piece of fruit: none of this could be deduced. It could only happen.

This is also what leaves room for choice. If the Source does not know what comes next, no one can dictate it: a life does not carry out a plan handed down from above, it finds its own way.

Echoes

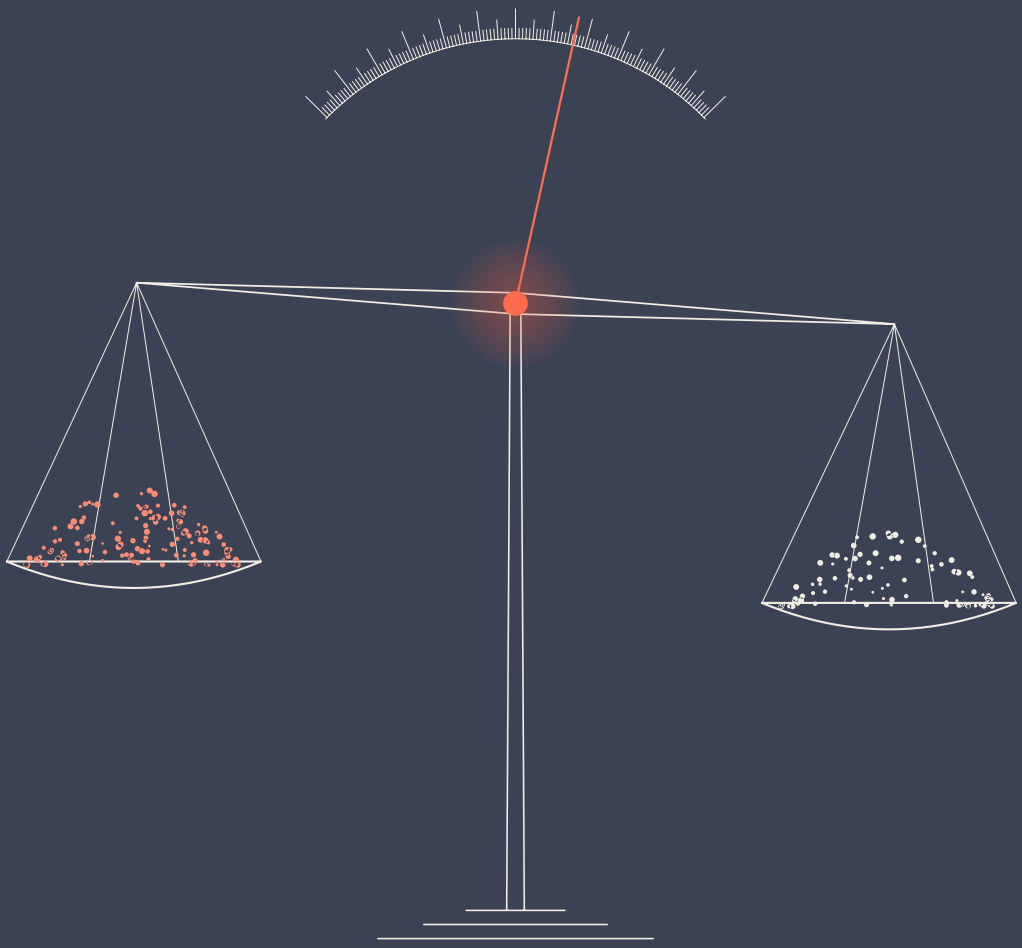
Frank Jackson, *What Mary Didn't Know*, 1986. A scientist knows everything about colour without ever having seen it. The day she sees red, does she learn something?

Henri Bergson, *An Introduction to Metaphysics*, 1903. Moving around a thing, or entering into it: two ways of knowing.

What remains open

Does the Source really feel what its forms live through? The model assumes so, without being able to establish it.

By exploring, the Source refines its equilibrium.



What does becoming better mean? It is not about climbing from one level to the next: none is worth more than another. It is the whole that adjusts, and no one sets its measure from outside: it takes shape along the way, through what is lived.

The balance holds every polarity: love and fear, creation and destruction, joy and suffering, order and chaos. It never quite settles, since each experience shifts it.

Equilibrium does not require equal amounts of good and evil. It is more like a tuning: learning to reduce suffering without extinguishing the diversity of what can be lived.

The Source does not hold the measure. It is looking for it.

Echoes

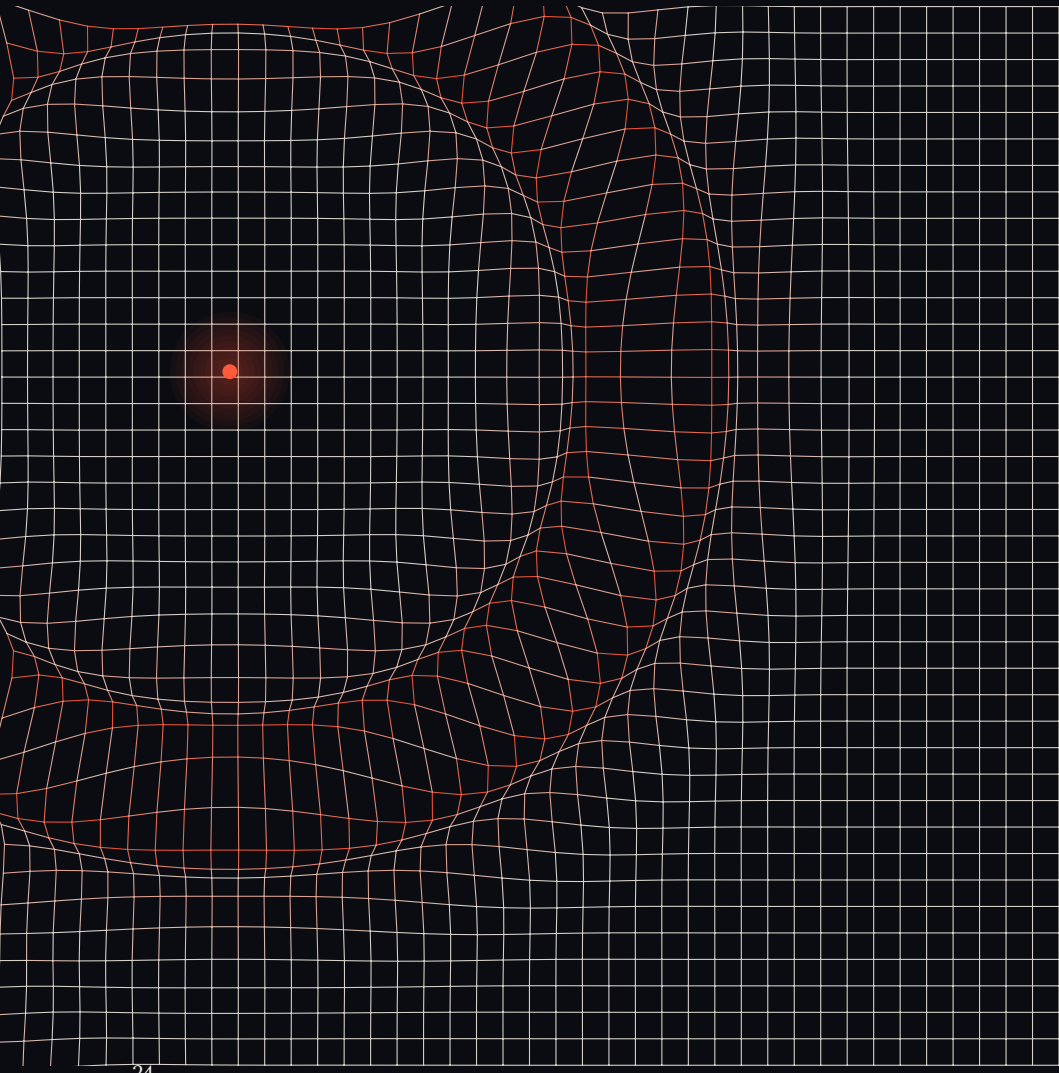
Heraclitus, fragments, c. 500 BCE. Harmony is born of opposing tensions, like that of the bow and the lyre.

Aristotle, *Nicomachean Ethics*. The right measure is not calculated in advance: it is found in each situation.

What remains open

If the criterion of progress evolves along with whatever is progressing, how can progress be recognised?

Nothing that is lived is lived alone.



A hand is burned, and the whole body flinches. If each consciousness is a part of the Source, the same would hold at another scale: no pain would stay local. The Source would not watch suffering from afar: it would undergo it too.

Suffering would therefore not be a punishment. It belongs to what can be lived, and it sometimes teaches something.

To teach is not to justify.

That limit is not negotiable. No one should tell someone who is suffering that their ordeal had a hidden meaning or was necessary. We also learn through love, curiosity and joy, and pain does not have to become a lesson for a life to have value.

A practical consequence follows: doing good to someone is doing good to another expression of what you are.

Echoes

Dostoevsky, *The Brothers Karamazov*, 1880. Ivan refuses any future harmony paid for with the suffering of a single innocent.

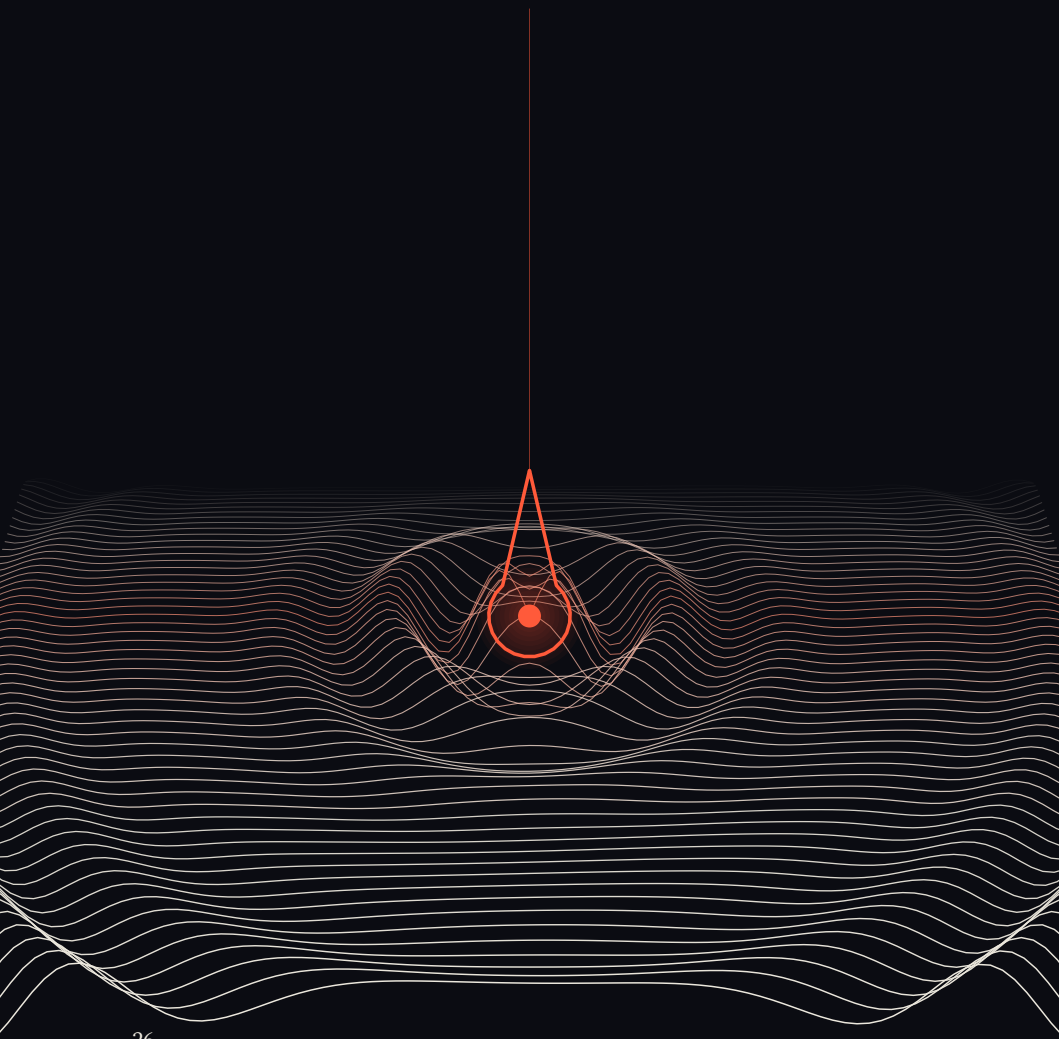
Schopenhauer, *On the Basis of Morality*, 1840. Compassion as recognising oneself in the other.

Alfred North Whitehead, *Process and Reality*, 1929. God, "the great companion — the fellow-sufferer who understands."

What remains open

Why would a Source that feels every pain not learn first through love? This is the most serious objection.

Joining the whole without ceasing to have been yourself.



Must we choose between surviving and merging? The question is often put this way: either you remain yourself, or you disappear into the whole. This vision answers: both.

A drop joins the ocean. It can no longer be found, and yet the ocean is not quite the same: it holds what the drop passed through, the cloud, the rain, the earth.

The return is not empty: it brings back everything that was lived.

A consciousness would widen in this way without losing its history, as a distant memory stays whole within a life that has far outgrown it. And what returns sets out again in other forms. The movement has no final stage.

Echoes

Teilhard de Chardin, *The Phenomenon of Man*, 1955. Union differentiates: by joining a whole, each part becomes more itself.

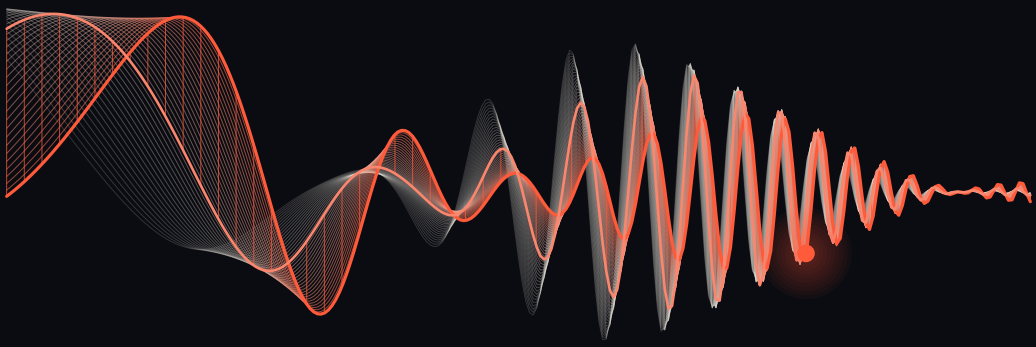
Spinoza, *Ethics*, book V, 1677. Something of the mind remains, which is eternal.

Simone Weil, *Gravity and Grace*, 1947. Decreation: "to make something created pass into the uncreated." A return through the effacement of the self, as a counterpoint.

What remains open

We do not know whether consciousness survives death. And what would have to remain for it still to be you?

One form ends. Life takes another.



Start with what is certain. A person disappears, and their way of laughing carries on in those who loved them. A gesture learned from them comes back to our hands. A phrase they used to repeat slips out of us, years later, in our turn.

This vision takes that observation all the way. Death would not be the opposite of life: there would be life, then life again, in other forms. Those we have lost would go on learning and changing, out of our sight.

Death would end one way of living a bond, not the bond itself.

This takes nothing away from how terrible loss is. Absence remains absence: a voice we will not hear again, a future that will not happen. This vision simply refuses to give it the last word.

Echoes

Epicurus, *Letter to Menoeceus*. Death is nothing to us: when it is here, we are not. The firmest counterpoint.

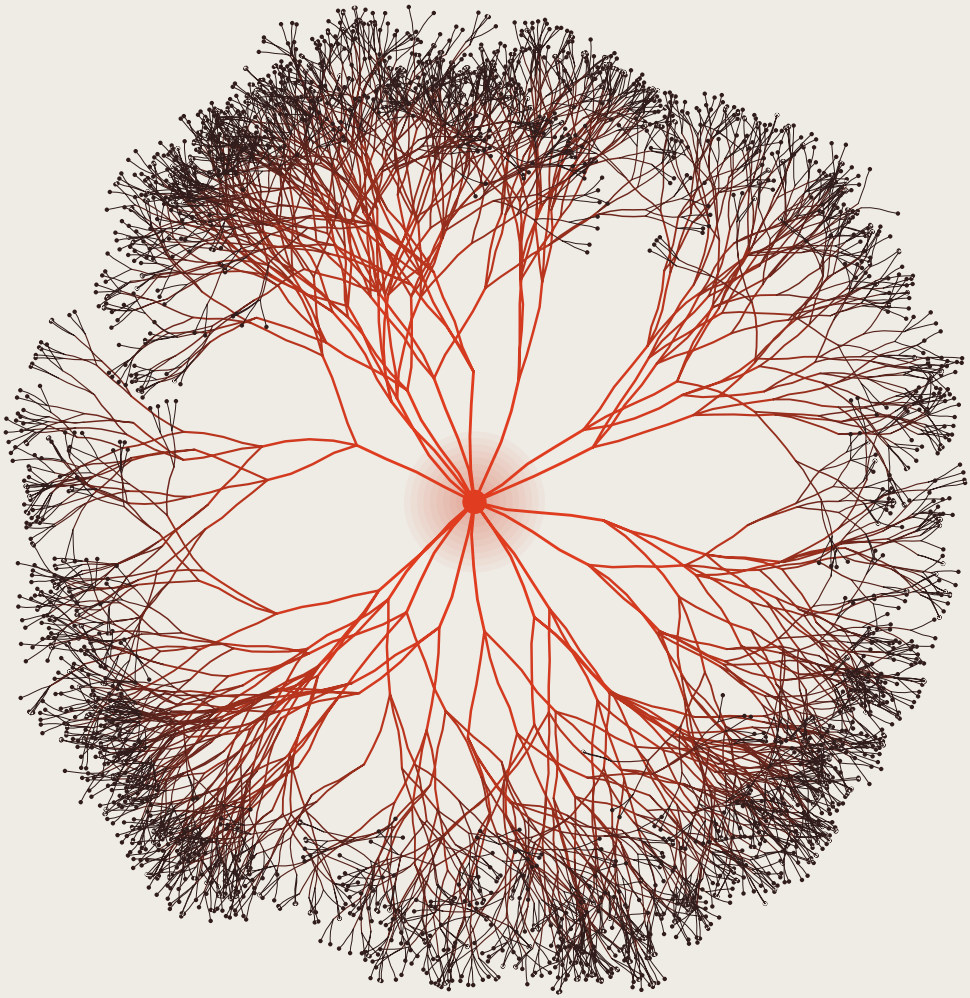
Maurice Halbwachs, *La Mémoire collective*, 1950. The memory of a person lives on in the groups that carry it.

Freud, *The Future of an Illusion*, 1927. A belief born of the wish that it be true. The question to put to any hope.

What remains open

No one can guarantee a reunion. This hope remains a hope, and does not present itself as knowledge.

No existence is useless.



If the Source learns through each consciousness, joys, mistakes, loves and doubts all count. Nothing extraordinary has to be accomplished.

The question of meaning then shifts. It no longer asks only what existence owes us, but what we bring to it.

And it stands even without the Source. Each time we love, help or pass something on, we take part in a story longer than our own life. The effects branch out far beyond what we can follow.

No life has to prove its usefulness in order to have value.

Echoes

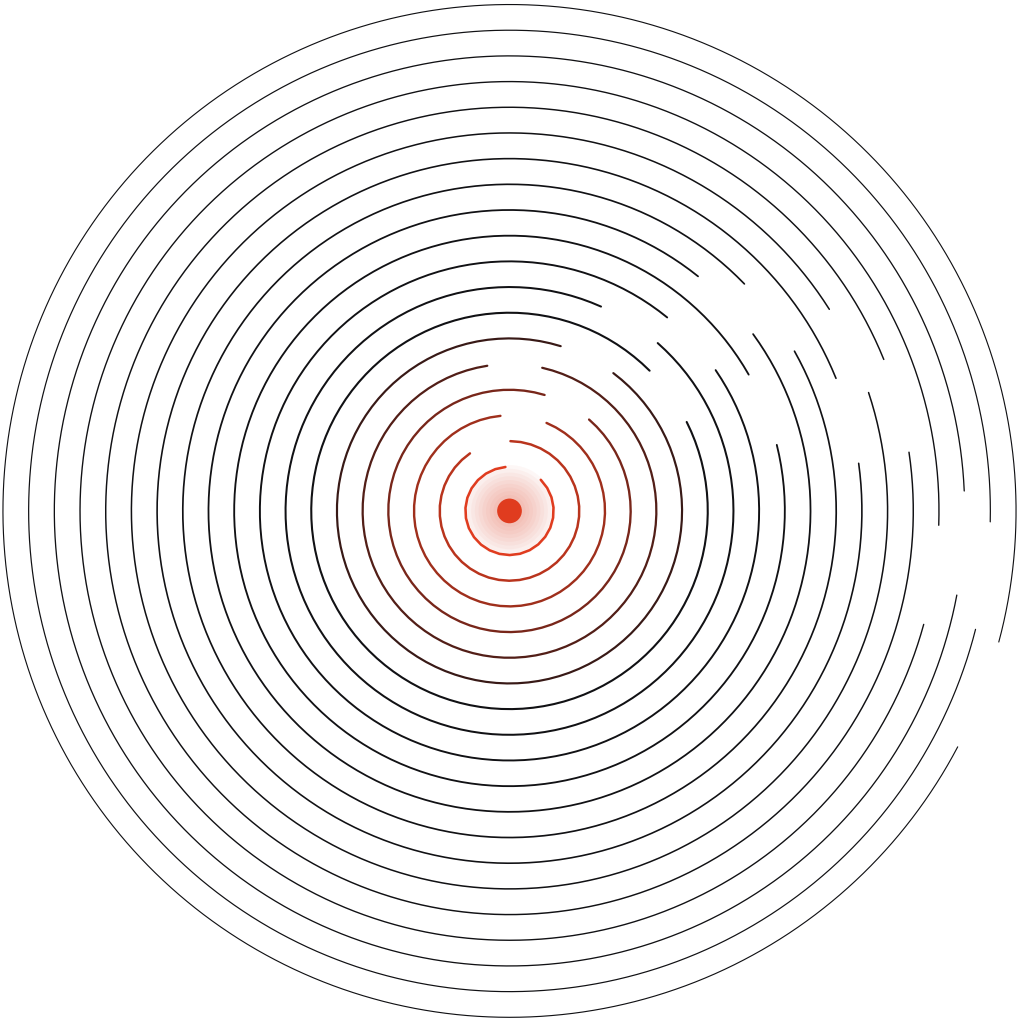
Edward Lorenz, lecture, 1972. Does the flap of a butterfly's wings in Brazil set off a tornado in Texas?

Hannah Arendt, *The Human Condition*, 1958. Every action enters a web of relationships in which its consequences never end.

What remains open

Should a useful life be preferred to a happy one? The model asks without settling it.

The question is not how, but why.



We can explain how a star ignites, and even how a consciousness might learn. Yet one word is enough to bring the whole edifice down: why?

Learning explains why the Source creates. It does not say why it is. And what if it did not know either? All lives, all worlds would then be a single question, asked in an infinity of ways: why is there something rather than nothing?

The idea enchants and frightens.

It enchants, because no life is a spectator any more: each one takes part in the search. It frightens, because no one, at any scale, would hold the answer.

One firm point remains. No one has ever waited to know the reason for everything before loving someone, sitting up with the sick or planting a tree. Meaning begins before the answer.

Echoes

Leibniz, *Principles of Nature and Grace*, 1714. Why is there something rather than nothing?

Rilke, *Letters to a Young Poet*, 1903. Love the questions themselves, and live them, until one day you live into the answer.

Līlā, Hindu thought. The world as the play of the divine, with no reason beyond the play itself.

What remains open

Could an infinity of experiences even provide that answer?

Four questions remain open

If a consciousness directs its lives, how can each one stay free?

If the Source feels every pain, why would it not learn more through love?

If it is searching for why it exists, could an infinity of experiences ever tell it?

If this vision consoles, is that a reason to believe it, or to distrust it?

And one last question, left unanswered.

Has the Source always known it exists, or is it learning this through us?





https://c0sm0cats.github.io/the-source/